



Photograph Jiten Gandhi

Every month, *Digit* will carry a caption for a photo. Come up with something funnier, and beat the *Digit* team at their own game! Entries accepted by the 15th of this month.

Beat That!

Digit Caption
"Computing, Unplugged!"

Last Month's Winner!

Anubhaw Shrivastav,
S.B.I, D.B, Saraiya, Muzaffarpur,
Bihar-843126

"Where's the Recycle-bin in
this Network Neighbourhood?"



E-mail your caption with the subject "Beat That", and your postal address, to beatthat@thinkdigit.com and win **C& Data Structures** by P.S. Deshpande & O.G. Kakde Published by Dreamtech, New Delhi



Speaking at the launch, Jobs said the Nano was an entirely new ground-up design. He went on to add that the iPod Nano is the biggest revolution since the original iPod.

Not changing the basics of the iPod that made it a runaway success and a benchmark for MP3 players, the Nano includes a click wheel for navigating songs and uses a standard 30-pin dock connector for compatibility with existing iPod accessories. Songs can be transferred from iTunes using USB 2.0. However, one of the major changes is the use of Flash memory - like in the Shuffle - which gives the Nano a battery life of 14 hours.

The iPod Nano was launched in two sizes—4 GB and 2 GB - and two colours, black and white. The 4 GB variant is priced at \$249 (approx Rs 12,000) while the 2 GB model will cost \$199 (about Rs 9,000).

Along with the player, Apple also launched accessories including a Rs 1,300 dock, a Rs 1,800 lanyard with inbuilt headphones, and armbands

that cost about Rs 1,300 each. The Nano also has a protective rubber case ('tubes' as Apple calls them), which will be sold in boxes of five colours for Rs 1,300.

The second part of this special event saw Apple, Motorola and Cingular Wireless launch Motorola ROKR, the world's first mobile phone with iTunes, which could hold up to a hundred songs from the iTunes jukebox. The iTunes software on the ROKR features easy to use menus, simple navigation and playback, and the ability to simply switch from phone to music and back again with the push of a dedicated music key. The ROKR has a colour display for viewing album art and features built-in dual-stereo speakers, as well as stereo headphones that also serve as a mobile headset with microphone.

As of right now, the ROKR is available only in the US, but will be available across the world in phases by the end of this year.

Announcing the promotional plans for the

ROKR, Motorola announced it had recruited ten music industry stars for a television ad. In fact, the filming of the ad had already been completed in London. The ad features pop stars from every relevant generation and genre including veterans Madonna, Little Richard, and Bootsy Collins, as well as pop punk rockers Sum 41, R&B diva Mya, king of crunk Lil' Jon, pop sensation The Pussycat Dolls, The White Stripes duo, and Billie Joe from Green Day. Through impersonators, the ad also features the likenesses of Beethoven and the late Jimi Hendrix and Biggie Smalls.

Now, we have had a chance to track the response to both products, and while the Nano is being hailed as the best thing since sliced bread (it's actually thinner!) and the ROKR is generating enough interest to suggest good sales, the inclusion of stars as old (and strange) as the list above suggests could affect sales adversely. But hey, what do we know?

CHINESE CHECKERS

Google Losing Ground In China?

Recent reports on the Net suggest Google may be losing ground in China to its competitor there, Baidu.com. The article that appeared on Yahoo! cites a recent study released by a Chinese Internet research group.

According to the article, the survey, conducted by Beijing-based China Internet Network Information Center, reported that Baidu.com Inc. boosted its marketshare in Beijing by 10.8 percentage points to 52 per cent. Google's share was at 33 per cent—the search giant kept its customer base steady as the overall market grew.

There are also noises being made that cite this more as a personal interest indulgence by Yahoo! rather than anything based on hard facts. The wars just get murkier.